

Windows 10X

What happened to the lightweight version of Windows 10?

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When Windows 10 first launched in 2015, Microsoft famously called it the 'last version of Windows'. This is why everyone thought the next version of Windows would be more of a big features update, called Windows 10X, because there will never be a Windows 11, right? Wrong.

Microsoft's Vice President of Program Management, Windows Servicing and Delivery, John Cable, who is literally the man deciding when, where and what is added to the next Windows update, wrote in a blog post: "Instead of bringing a product called Windows 10X to market in 2021 like we originally intended, we are leveraging learnings from our journey thus far and accelerating the integration of key foundational 10X technology into other parts of Windows and products at the company."

Windows 10X, since the start of its development, was thought to be an operating system that was to be the one true competitor of Chrome OS and iPad OS, with the latter one coming into the picture only after Apple made leaps of progress in its iPad Pro line of products. Microsoft has been trying to penetrate the handheld computers and the prosumer market segment with its Surface line of products, and Windows 10 X was meant to cater to that goal of the company.

It would have been a stripped-down version of Windows that was capable of handling whatever was thrown at it while consuming a fraction of the system resources that its

beefed-up sibling did. The previous attempts of Microsoft at developing something similar date back to 2012, when the company released Windows RT to be loaded onto its first Surface Tablet. They followed it up with Windows 10 S, which released in 2017. The company had made a lot of efforts with the launch of Windows 10 S, pushing it to be the norm in the student markets of the world.

In its amplified efforts in pushing this latest and greatest and lightest iteration of Windows, the company announced that the devices with Win-

improvements expected, but the program got scrapped altogether.

In the same blog post where the announcement regarding the shutting down of the development of Windows 10 X had been made, John Cable wrote, "Our teams continue to invest in areas where the 10X technology will help meet our customer needs as well as evaluate technology experiences both in software and hardware that will be useful to our customers in the future."

It was all going to be a short-lived narrative, though, as only a month later, (at the start of June 2021),



Windows 10X – The Windows 10 successor that never came to be

dows 10 S on it would cost as little as \$189, with a load of services coming in for free as a complementary addition to the whole package. There was to be a free subscription to Minecraft: Education Edition for new Windows 10 Education PCs and Microsoft Office 365 for Education and Microsoft Teams. Moreover, the entire operating system was to be given to all the schools running a genuine Windows Pro PC. All of this was promised and delivered too.

With Windows 10 X, there were many quality of life and operational

rumoured builds of Windows 11 started doing rounds on the internet. And it wasn't long before Microsoft themselves, on the 24th of June, made the official announcement regarding the release of Windows 11, an OS that was "Redesigned for productivity, creativity and ease".

We may never get to see what Windows 10 X would have been like to use, but now that we have Windows 11, we cannot really predict what Microsoft's next move is going to be. Let's wait and see what the latest and greatest version of Windows has in store for us. 